

Foundations, Under Exam Conditions

Lesson 10 — Essay practice: the Middle East to 1952

What you will know and be able to do

1

Write a complete, timed essay drawing on everything from Lessons 6–9

2

Apply command-term discipline, structure, historiography, and evaluation together

3

Self-assess against the criteria built since Lesson 1

4

Close Block B1 ready to go deeper into Nasser's Egypt and Arab nationalism

Four lessons of content, one full test

The mandate legacy, the Partition Plan and 1948 war, its consequences, and Egypt's fall of its monarchy — all now covered. Today tests whether you can actually build an essay from this material under real conditions, before we go deeper into Nasser's era.

A full argument-evaluation essay

“The unresolved contradictions of the mandate era, more than any single event after 1945, explain the instability of the post-war Middle East.” To what extent do you agree?

A representative Paper 3 style question drawing on Lessons 6–9.

PRACTICE • 40 MIN

Write your complete essay now

Write a full essay in response to today's question, under real time pressure, without looking back at earlier lesson slides until you finish.

- Plan your position and structure before writing a single sentence
- Use specific evidence from at least three of Lessons 6–9
- Integrate at least one genuine historiographical reference
- Reach a real, specific judgement in your conclusion

Checking your own essay

Did your introduction state a clear position immediately? Did each paragraph advance one point, tied explicitly back to the claim? Did you address a genuine counter-argument, not a weak one? Did your conclusion reach an actual judgement, not a summary?

What a strong final judgement sounds like

“The mandate era's unresolved contradictions, especially over Palestine, created conditions for instability that later events then activated — but the specific decisions made in 1947–48, and their consequences for Egypt's monarchy by 1952, gave that instability its actual, specific shape. The mandate legacy set the stage; it did not, alone, write the play.”

What Block B2 builds on this foundation

Everything from this sub-block — the Arab League's limits, 1948's outcome, and Egypt's revolutionary new government — sets up exactly what Block B2 covers next: how Nasser turned Egypt into the centre of a wider Arab nationalist movement, and how that movement collided directly with Britain, France, and Israel at Suez in 1956.

Block B1 recap

Mandate contradiction

Britain's incompatible promises regarding Palestine's future.

New Historians

Israeli historians revising the dominant 1948 narrative from the late 1970s.

Nakba / War of Independence

The dual naming of the 1948 war, reflecting genuinely different experiences.

Free Officers

The Egyptian army movement that ended the monarchy in 1952.

What we now understand before Nasser's Egypt

A region inheriting unresolved mandate-era contradictions, a war that redrew its map and displaced a people under two different names, and a revolutionary new government in Egypt with regional ambitions still to come. Every later lesson on Nasser assumes you remember this foundation.

Lesson 11 — Nasser and the rise of Arab nationalism

Next lesson starts Block B2: how Nasser turned domestic revolution into a regional ideology, and why so many Arabs beyond Egypt's own borders began to see him as their leader too.